April 19

Met with Repub. Congressional leadership. The budget was the subject. I think they are relieved to learn that I'm willing to compromise some in return for a bipartisan program. I called Tip O'Neill. I'm not sure he's ready to give. Tip is truly a New Deal liberal. He honestly believes that we're promoting welfare for the rich.

April 23

. . . the group debating the budget seems unable to arrive at any kind of consensus. If we can't get a bipartisan agreement to act together in the face of the projected deficit, then I take to the air—TV—and there will be blood on the floor.

April 26

. . . at 10:15 addressed 2000 delegates of the U.S. Chambers of Commerce convention. What a shot in the arm. They interrupted me a dozen times or more. I was talking about the budget and our economic program. [Later,] a budget meeting. The gang goes back at it with the Dems tomorrow. I felt they were tiring a lot and the Dems are holding out for more concessions. The Dems are playing games—they want me to rescind the third year of the tax cuts—not in a million years!

April 27

Well, it looks like the three weeks of budget talks got nowhere. The Dems are after a campaign issue and from Tip's words to the press and Jim Wright's, I think it will be that my recovery plan failed *[it hasn't started]*. Well, I'm meeting Tip tomorrow afternoon.

April 28